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comprehensive victories against Monza and Como. New signings Scott McTominay, Romelu Lukaku, and David Neres found the back of the net against Cesc Fabregas-led Como to take a two-point advantage over second-placed Inter Milan.

Inter bounced back from its derby loss against AC Milan with 3-2 wins against Udinese and Torino, with Marcus Thuram grabbing a hat-trick against the latter.

Italian giant Juventus made it four draws in its last five league games after playing out a 1-1 stalemate against Cagliari. Despite being the only unbeaten side in the league, Thiago Motta's side sits third in the table with 13 points from seven games.

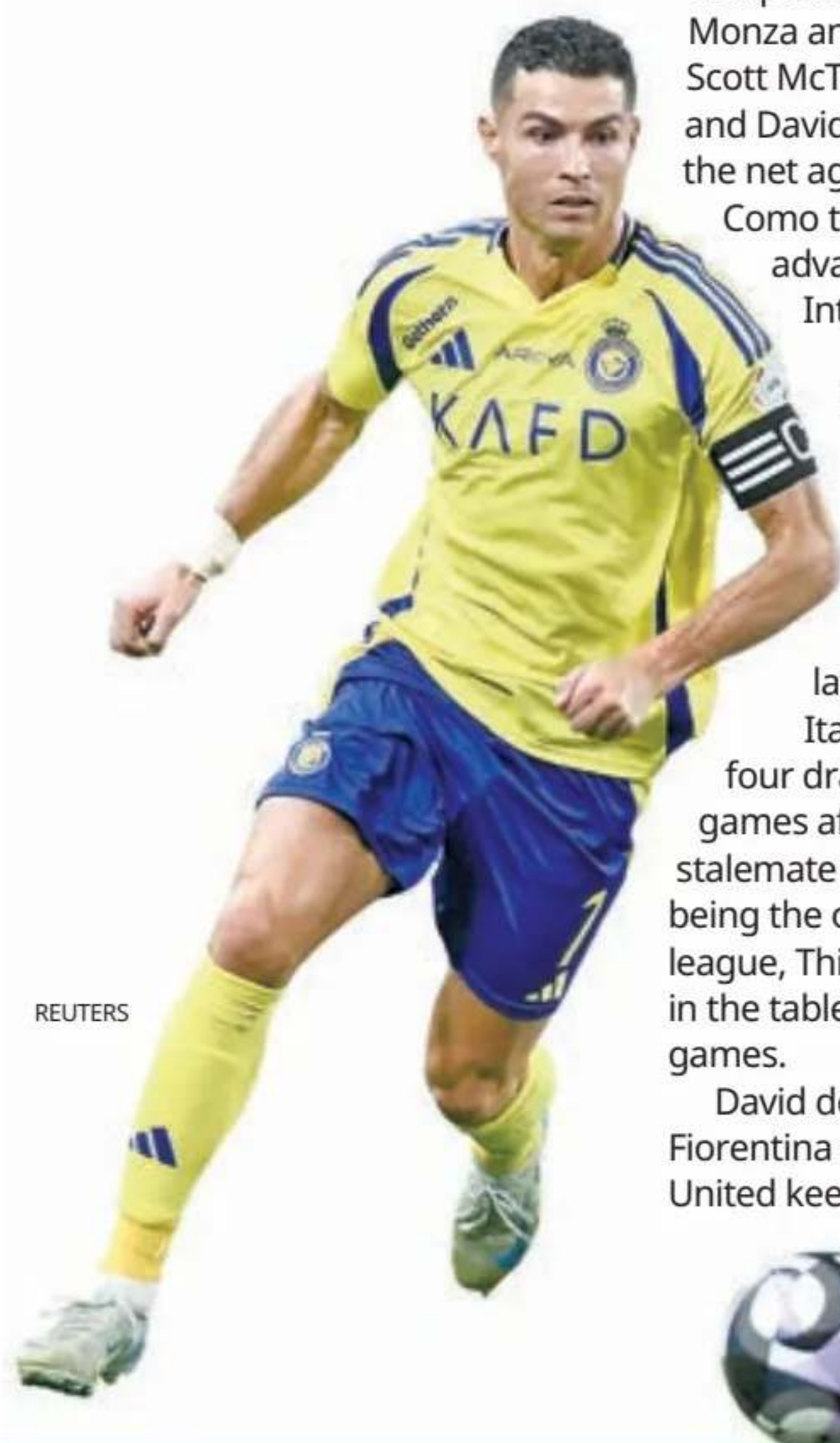
David de Gea was the hero for Fiorentina as the former Manchester United keeper saved two penalties to

help his side cause an upset against Milan, winning 2-1. The loss means Milan will go into the break in sixth place with 11 points, five behind leader Napoli.

Around the world

Major League Soccer: Lionel Messi (**above**) secured his second title with Inter Miami after scoring twice to beat defending MLS champion Columbus Crew 3-2 to clinch the Supporters' Shield, awarded for the best regular season record. He went on to feature as a second-half substitute in the 1-0 victory against Toronto FC, where Leonardo Campana scored a stoppage-time winner.

Saudi Pro League: Cristiano Ronaldo (**left**) announced his return to Al Nassr from illness by converting from the spot in the 2-0 win against Al Wehda. The following week, he put away another penalty to score his 905th career goal. Sadio Mane scored a brace as Nassr beat Al Orobah 3-0.



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